

Acceptable Use Policy (AUP)

Policy No: POL-IT-002 | Version: v1.4 | Department: IT Department | Effective: March 17, 2026

1. PURPOSE

This Acceptable Use Policy defines the appropriate use of the organization's IT resources including computers, networks, internet, email, and software. It aims to protect employees, the organization, and its partners from legal, security, and operational risks.

2. SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and authorized users who access company-owned or company-managed IT systems, networks, and data — whether on-premise or remotely.

3. TABLE OF CONTENTS

Section	Title
4	Permitted Use
5	Prohibited Activities
6	Internet Usage
7	Software & Downloads
8	Monitoring & Privacy
9	Consequences of Misuse

4. PERMITTED USE

Company IT resources are provided to support legitimate business activities. Employees may use these resources for:

- Conducting work-related research and communication.
- Accessing business applications and company data necessary for job duties.
- Limited personal use during breaks, provided it does not interfere with work, consume excessive bandwidth, or violate any part of this policy.
- Professional development activities approved by the line manager.

Note: Incidental personal use is permitted but must remain minimal and appropriate.

5. PROHIBITED ACTIVITIES

The following activities are strictly prohibited on company IT resources:

5.1 Illegal Activities

- Accessing, downloading, or distributing illegal content.
- Engaging in copyright infringement, software piracy, or unauthorized duplication.
- Conducting any activity that violates local, national, or international law.

5.2 Security Threats

- Installing unauthorized software, hacking tools, or malware.
- Attempting to bypass security controls, firewalls, or access restrictions.
- Sharing login credentials with other individuals.
- Using company resources for cryptocurrency mining.

5.3 Inappropriate Content

- Accessing or distributing pornographic, hateful, discriminatory, or offensive content.
- Engaging in online harassment, bullying, or threatening behavior.
- Posting confidential company information on public forums or social media.

6. INTERNET USAGE

6.1 General Guidelines

Internet access is provided for business purposes. While limited personal use is tolerated, employees must exercise good judgment and ensure productivity is not impacted.

6.2 Bandwidth Usage

Streaming media, large file downloads, and bandwidth-intensive applications unrelated to work are prohibited during business hours. Such activities may impact network performance for all users.

6.3 Safe Browsing

- Do not click on suspicious links or pop-up advertisements.
- Avoid websites flagged by the company web filter.
- Do not enter company credentials on external or personal websites.

7. SOFTWARE & DOWNLOADS

- Only IT-approved software may be installed on company devices.
- Employees must not download freeware, shareware, or software from untrusted sources.
- All software requests must be submitted through the IT Helpdesk portal.
- Software license agreements must be respected at all times.
- Browser extensions and plugins require IT approval before installation.

Note: Unauthorized software installations will be detected during routine audits and may be removed without notice.

8. MONITORING & PRIVACY

Employees should have no expectation of privacy when using company IT resources. The organization reserves the right to monitor, log, and audit all activities on company systems and networks.

- Internet browsing history may be monitored.
- Email communications sent via company email may be reviewed.
- Keystrokes and screen activity may be logged on monitored systems.
- All monitoring is conducted in compliance with applicable privacy laws.

Note: Personal devices used for work purposes (BYOD) are subject to monitoring of company data and applications only.

9. CONSEQUENCES OF MISUSE

Misuse of company IT resources is taken seriously and may result in:

- Verbal or written warning for minor first-time offences.
- Suspension of IT access privileges pending investigation.
- Disciplinary action up to and including termination.
- Civil or criminal prosecution for illegal activities.

All incidents are documented and investigated by HR in coordination with IT Security.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I, the undersigned, confirm that I have read, understood, and agree to comply with this policy. I understand that violation of this policy may result in disciplinary action.

Employee Name:	_____	Date:	_____
Employee ID:	_____	Signature:	_____
Department :	_____	Manager:	_____

For questions regarding this policy, contact the IT Department at it-policy@company.com